Danilo Aristizabal



Labor and Development Economist | Applied Microeconimist

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PROFILE

Economist with a PhD in Economics from Universidad de los Andes and over seven years of experience conducting applied research in labor economics, development economics, public policy, and social protection. My research focuses on labor informality, employment, labor taxation, workforce development, and social policy in developing economies. I combine administrative and household survey data with modern causal inference methods to generate policy-relevant evidence.

I have conducted research at Banco de la República, Universidad de los Andes, and the World Bank, contributing to academic publications and policy discussions on labor markets and economic development in Latin America and other developing regions.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Labor Economics
- Development Economics
- Labor Informality
- Labor Market Institutions
- Social Protection Systems
- Taxation and Labor Markets
- Applied Microeconometrics

EDUCATION

2025 PhD in Economics, Universidad de los Andes.
2020 MA in Economics, Universidad de los Andes.
2017 MA in Economic Analysis, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid.
2015 BA in Accounting, Universidad Nacional de Colombia.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Consultant: World Bank, Social Protection and Labor Global Practice (ASPIRE Team) 2022–Present

- Designed and conducted applied research on labor markets and social protection systems across developing economies.
- Produced analytical reports and policy notes informing social protection and labor reforms.

- Lead harmonization and analysis of household survey and administrative data covering more than 80 countries.
- Generate evidence on poverty, vulnerability, labor market outcomes, and social protection performance for policymakers and development partners.
- Collaborate with government counterparts, World Bank team, and international experts on policy-oriented analytical projects.

Research Assistant, Banco de la República 2021-2022

- Conducted empirical research on labor market outcomes, labor informality, and employment dynamics in Colombia.
- Managed and analyzed large administrative and survey datasets.
- Produced statistical evidence and analytical inputs for academic and policy-oriented research projects.
- Applied causal inference techniques to study labor market institutions and employment outcomes.

Research Analyst, CEDE, Universidad de los Andes, 2019-2021

- Participated in research projects on labor markets, economic development, and public policy.
- Managed and analyzed large household survey datasets.
- Supported the implementation of econometric analyses and impact evaluations.
- Contributed to academic publications and policy reports.

SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

Labor Informality in Colombia

Research on labor and business informality using household surveys GEIH and EMICRON to understand the determinants and consequences of informality in Colombia.

Payroll Taxes, Wage Rigidities, and Youth Employment

Ongoing research evaluating the relationship between labor taxation, wage-setting institutions, and labor market outcomes among young workers.

Workforce Development and Formal Employment

Research assessing the effectiveness of training programs in promoting transitions into formal employment in Bogota.

Social Protection Performance in Developing Countries

Cross-country analysis of social protection systems, including coverage, targeting, adequacy, and poverty reduction impacts.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Laajaj et al. (2022). *Understanding how socioeconomic inequalities drive inequalities in COVID-19 infections*. Scientific Reports.

Bardey et al. (2022). *Concentration of Mobile Phone Markets and countries' competitiveness*. Telecommunications Policy.

Laajaj et al. (2021). *SARS-CoV-2 spread, detection, and dynamics in a megacity in Latin America*. Nature Communications.

Policy Publications

Otero et al. (2025). *Nueva evidencia sobre la informalidad laboral y empresarial en Colombia*. ESPE.

WORKING PAPERS

Aristizabal, D. & Martínez, E. (2026). Payroll taxes, wage rigidities and youth unemployment: Evidence form Colombian labor market.

Aristizabal, D. (2026). Training courses and formal employment.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Universidad de los Andes:
2022–2024 Instructor, Econometrics II.
2023 TA, Labor Economics (Undergraduate).
2021–2022 TA, Econometrics (Undergraduate).
2019 TA, Macroeconomics (PhD).
2019 TA, Econometrics (PhD).

LANGUAGES

Spanish (Native). English (Fluent, C1 TOEFL).

REFERENCES

Marcela Eslava (Universidad de los Andes) – meslava@uniandes.edu.co
Oscar Becerra (Universidad de los Andes) – obecerra@uniandes.edu.co